

Storage. The choice of system storage is highly dependent on the nature of system use. Two main storage technologies available in the market are hard disk drive (HDD), which has a rotating magnetic platter with a read/write head to retrieve data, and solidstate drive (SSD), which stores information in microchips and relies on flash technology.

SSDs can hold the stored data even when there is no power, making system boot and data retrieval up to 30 per cent faster than HDD. Additionally, no moving parts means SSDs can run on less power, so these are battery-friendly as well.

However, SSDs are quite costlier than HDDs. Also, HDDs have larger storage capacity. For example, a 2TB HDD still costs less than a 1TB SSD. So HDD is the right option if you need a large storage space within a budget and can compromise a little bit on system-boot time. On the other hand, SSD is a better choice for faster system speed and performance.

Battery life, latest Wi-Fi support and more. Battery is an important part of the device you choose. Lithium polymer are the batteries of choice in most of today's devices. These come in capacities of 30-40 watt-hours (Wh). Opt for a laptop that has minimum battery life of 10 hours and battery capacity of around 40Wh.

Make sure that the laptop is dual-band Wi-Fi compatible (2.4GHz and 5.0GHz) and supports the latest AC Wi-Fi standard (802.11ac). Gigabit Ethernet port availability is another must-have feature.

Additionally, look for an accidental protection warranty. Some of the latest hybrid laptops come integrated with fingerprint sensors, which offer an added layer of security.

Options in the market

The hybrid laptop market is quite competitive with a lot of options to select from. We discuss here a few them.

Lenovo Yoga 520 series. Priced at about ₹ 40,000, this laptop is designed

for users on the run with around 10 hours of battery life and the latest 8th-generation Intel processors. It packs a decent 4GB DDR4 RAM, 1TB HDD storage, 36cm (14-inch) display, next-generation fingerprint reader, dual-AC Wi-Fi with Gigabit LAN port, Full HD IPS anti-glare display and one-year free accidental damage protection.

Acer Switch Alpha 12. Priced around ₹ 40,000, this 1.25kg laptop has a 4GB RAM, 256GB SSD storage and 2160x1440-pixel 30cm (12-inch) display. A major USP of this Windows 10 Home offering with inbuilt Intel HD graphics card is its liquid cooling facility, which the company claims to be the world's first in hybrid laptops. The laptop supports a battery life of 8 hours.

HP Pavilion x360 AB005TU. Priced below ₹ 30,000, this laptop is a decent pick. It packs a 1600MHz 4GB DDR3 RAM (with two SD slots expandable up to 8GB), 500GB HDD storage, 28cm (11-inch) intuitive touchscreen with HD display, Intel HD450 internal graphic processor unit and a strong 45W battery. The processor (Intel Pentium Quad-Core N3710 1.6GHz) is slightly weaker, but other features make up for it. The laptop costs ₹ 28,000.

Lava Twinpad T100. This cellular laptop is a good option if you are on a tight budget. It comes with a 3G SIM slot for data connectivity and a 1.33GHz Bay Trail T100 processor. Costing ₹ 14,999, this laptop has 2GB DDR3 RAM, 32GB flash storage, 25.6cm (10.1-inch) IPS display, Intel integrated graphics (Gen 7), and a 2MP front and a 2MP rear camera. It packs Windows 10 by default.

In a nutshell

Detachable laptops are capable of powerful computing despite reduced hardware. While traditional systems are preferred by business users owing to their better security and processing features, hybrid computers are a great companion for daily use on-the-move. **RFY**

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